



STATUS REPORT

Benin: status report

Edition of 2026-08-11 • 74 systems and instruments tracked, 4 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-11 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/BEN/ledger.csv](#) (74 systems and instruments, 4 of them Not held). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

One presidency-attached agency owns identity, the population register, the civil registry and the electoral register as a single integrated system, and its director general is also National Civil Registrar. [Biometric enrolment stands at about 98–99%](#). A national data exchange instituted by decree in 2020 has carried [more than 138 million requests](#), and its published conditions of access make the data-protection authority a step in the technical onboarding path rather than a complaint channel after the fact. That authority [publishes its caseload](#), holds a dedicated AI policy, and has made the electoral agency strip fields from the roll before publication.

Against that, the first per-programme execution figures Benin has ever published show the national digital programme at [0.62% of its credits ordonnancé at 30 April 2026](#), against 15.43% across all programmes. The ministry's own steering programme ran at 20.12%, so this is specific to the digital line rather than ministry-wide.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
5G networks	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Second operator live 2026-04-28
National fibre backbone	IMPLEMENTED ↗	More than 3,000 km in service (2026-02)

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National data centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In operation behind the cyber stack (2025-06)
Sovereign cloud and national cyber authority	PLANNED ↗	Urged by an expert roadmap to 2033 (2026-04)

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National digital-security stack	IMPLEMENTED ↗	CSIRT, PKI, forensic laboratory and critical-infrastructure policy in place

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
SECURROUTE road-enforcement data platform	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	In build from 2026-01-27

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cotonou cyber-hub programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	300 police unit heads trained in 2026

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Free roaming with Senegal and Togo	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Live 2026-04-24
Participation in regional cybercrime enforcement	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Carton Rouge 2.0 takedown, 651 arrests (2026-02)

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National vulnerability report	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First report published 2025-06-25

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
WARDIP second-phase regional digital financing	IMPLEMENTED ↗	US\$137m approved 2026-03-16

A [second 5G operator](#) launched in April 2026 alongside the incumbent's 2024 network; data prices fell from 4,000 to 995 FCFA a gigabyte between 2016 and 2023; more than 3,000 km of fibre underpins the service estate; and free roaming with Senegal and Togo began on 24 April 2026 under an ECOWAS regulation, with free incoming calls for thirty days. Regional financing arrived in March 2026: US\$137m for Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone, aimed at broadband for more than 5m people and digital public services for more than 5m more.

Benin has run a national digital-security strategy since 2020, and in June 2025 published a [first national vulnerability report](#): 878 vulnerabilities over 2021–2024, 23% of them critical, and institutional compliance ranging from 6% to 87%.

The agency reports more than 230 services delivered online and about 40 priority structures under tailored security oversight. An expert roadmap to 2033 recommends a sovereign cloud and a national cyber authority — neither of which exists.

Digital public infrastructure

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
AFIS fingerprint system wired to the regional police exchange	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Inaugurated 2025-09-30

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Customs system migration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	44 of 49 offices migrated (2025-02)
Electronic international waybill	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-05-22, mandatory after three months
Xroad-BJ national data exchange	IMPLEMENTED ↗	32.7m requests in 30 days (2026-07)

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Citizen mobile wallet	PLANNED ↗	Planned for end-2026
Diaspora biometric passport renewal platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Live 2025-10-24
Foundational biometric identity	IMPLEMENTED ↗	7.7m identification numbers issued (2026-05)

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cashless motorway tolls	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Live 2026-03-19
Mobile money	IMPLEMENTED ↗	88.09% penetration on 11.65m active accounts (2025-12)
Regional central bank digital currency	PILOTING ↗	e-CFA in pilot (2026-04)
Regional instant payment rail	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Banks and mobile money 100% interconnected (2026-05)

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Birth registration	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Single-window pilot at 10 maternities, 76.56%
e-Foncier national land cadastre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	445,695 parcels registered (2026-03)
National Register of Natural Persons	IMPLEMENTED ↗	About 200,000 authentications a day (2026-02)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Population register as the electoral roll	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Used for the presidential poll of 2026-04-12

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
e-Procurement platform	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	First build tender declared unsuccessful 2025-09-16
Justice-sector digitalisation plan 2026-2033	PLANNED ↗	Published 2026-07-24
Portail national des services publics	IMPLEMENTED ↗	More than 230 services routed through it (2026-06)

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Décret 2020-209 instituting the exchange	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed 2020-03-18
Extension of the biometric register to foreigners and Afro-descendants	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Law 2025-12, 2025-06-23
Identity-linked SIM registration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Unregistered SIMs deactivated from 2025-04-30
Tax measures pushing merchants onto digital rails	IMPLEMENTED ↗	1% levy on large cash payments, from 2025-01

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Mandatory digitisation of paper records	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Joint circular, 2026-07-24
National DPI roadmap	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Drafted 2026-07-31
Single-agency identity governance	IMPLEMENTED ↗	One presidency-attached agency owns all four registers

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign membership	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Joined 2026-06-02
ECOWAS-standard biometric identity card	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Issued to ECOWAS standard since 2020
Smart Africa cross-border data exchange	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Working with Rwanda and Ghana from 2026-04
Trilateral border-modernisation steering committee	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Joint Communiqué adopted 2026-07-27, establishing a Trilateral Strategic Steering Committee

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cadre d'interopérabilité	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In force from 2020-03-18
National Root Certification Authority and trust services	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Operating from 2026-07-01
PASI and PDAIE interoperability referentials	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Consultation opened 2026-07-01
Published conditions of access to the exchange	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Published 2026-07-28

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Consumer redress for failed mobile-money transactions	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Redress body established 2025-07-29
Free identity-card distribution by civil society	IMPLEMENTED ↗	More than 130,000 cards across nine communes (2026-05)

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Domestic payment aggregator	IMPLEMENTED ↗	More than 13,000 merchants (2026-05)

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Public reporting of exchange usage	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Directory published 2026-07-11

About 98–99% biometric coverage sits under a register connecting more than 80 institutions at about 200,000 authentications a day, with [at least 75% of identification services accessed digitally](#) in 2025. But [between 2021 and 2025 about 2.5m births were declared against under 1m actually registered](#). A single-window pilot at ten maternities lifted registration to 76.56% against about 22% nationally, and generalisation slipped three to four months.

The register is also the electoral roll. The agency compiled and managed the list for the 12 April 2026 presidential poll. A civil-society organisation issued more than 130,000 free cards across nine communes, which showed the gap between the older enrolment campaign and card issuance — failed fingerprints and dead enrolment numbers.

The exchange was instituted by decree in 2020 on an X-Road-lineage platform and now reports more than 138 million requests. In July 2026 its operator [published what a body must satisfy before connecting](#) — for a private body, data-protection authority authorisation before first connection.

Payments run on the regional rail rather than a national one. Banks and mobile money were fully interconnected by May 2026, and [mobile-money penetration reached 88.09% on 11.65m active accounts](#) at end-2025.

On regional border cooperation, the customs administrations of Nigeria, Cameroon and Benin [adopted a Joint Communiqué on 27 July 2026](#), following a benchmarking mission to the Beitbridge and Chirundu border posts, committing to a Trilateral Strategic Steering Committee to carry the Beitbridge modernisation and concession model onto the Sèmè-Kraké and Mfum-Ekok corridors.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Data-localisation law	PLANNED ↗	Committed in the presidential programme (2026-03)

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Machinery of government for digital	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Portfolio changed hands 2026-05-27
Presidential programme 2026-2033 digital commitments	PLANNED ↗	Published 2026-03-21
Stratégie numérique 2031	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Drafting opened 2026-02-05
Vision Bénin 2060 digital pillar	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Published 2026-02-03

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cotonou Declaration on a single digital market	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Adopted 2025-11-19
Data-protection cooperation conventions	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed with Senegal and Mali 2026-04-17

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Data protection authority	IMPLEMENTED ↗	907 files examined, 14 sanctioned (2025 report)
Enforcement against the electoral agency	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Fields stripped before publication (2026-05)

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Data-protection authority AI policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Adopted 2026-05-16

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Open Government Partnership national action plan	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Co-creation opened 2026-07-29

The data-protection authority was created by the Code du numérique, publishes a numbered annual report, holds a dedicated AI policy with strict purpose limitation, and has required the electoral agency to strip extraneous fields from the roll before publication. It names its own gaps as the absence of algorithmic-audit tooling and budget.

Policy is being rewritten around a new government: on 27 May the digital portfolio changed hands and the ministry was renamed Transformation Digitale et Innovation with an explicit AI-strategy mandate. A decree moved the budget programme codes at the same time, so any Benin budget series keyed on ministry breaks at 24 May 2026.

The incoming programme commits, in its own words, to a data-localisation law, national supercomputers and a state platform monetising locally produced data — and counts a government AI super app among the foundations it already has. Nothing held establishes that the super app exists.

On openness, an [Open Budget Survey 2025 score of 77/100 on transparency](#), fifth globally, from 1/100 in 2012 — while the annual performance reports its own organic budget law requires have never been published for any year.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
AI, drone and geospatial malaria programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	US\$2.3m programme with Japanese financing

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Six-country francophone AI-governance framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Taken to the UN Global AI Dialogue 2026-07-09

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Generative-AI compliance regime for public agents	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In force from 2026-06-01

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Fon-language voice AI	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2025-06-30

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National AI and big-data strategy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The 2023-2027 strategy in force
Government AI super app	NOT HELD	—

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Domestic content-verification platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Founded 2025, operating (2026-07)

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
India digital cooperation	NOT HELD	—

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National AI Olympiad	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First edition held 2026-07-09

The 2023–2027 national strategy took the country from 145th globally to the sub-Saharan top five on an AI-readiness index in three years.

In June 2026 the digital agency published a [framework for generative AI in the public service](#) that starts from an admission — public agents already use these tools on personal accounts outside any framework — and orders a census of those users, a binding charter, and contracts forbidding any use of administration data to train models. The framework also states that contractual terms do not close the sovereignty risk, because the model, the infrastructure and the jurisdiction remain another party's.

Two capability programmes are on record, in language and in health. The first voice-to-voice AI in Fon was built for mother-tongue service access — and an [AI, drone and geospatial malaria programme](#) costing US\$2.3m reports incidence down 38% and mortality down 39% across 2022–2024.

The domestic commercial layer is early: a content-verification platform founded in 2025, and a strategy co-author arguing in print for frugal domestic AI against a GPU-scarcity route to AI becoming a luxury good.

Inclusion and capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National tele-teaching platform	PLANNED ↗	Authorised for 2026-27 across four universities
State RSSI certification programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cohort of 25 opened 2026-08-03
Sèmè City skills hub network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Hub network with a Sorbonne partnership

The explanatory note to the 2026 rectifying budget embedded raw financial-system output showing programme 111 *Numérique* at 0.62% ordonnancé at 30 April 2026 against 15.43% across all programmes. The ministry's own steering programme ran at 20.12% over the same period.

The data-protection authority carries its own budget line across three estimates volumes. The digital agency that runs the CSIRT, the data centre and the PKI has no visible line in any of them. The identity agency likewise carries no programme of its own, and the telecoms regulator never appears in the finance law at all, funded from fees that fell 26.9% between 2024 and 2025.

The annual performance reports the organic budget law requires have never been published for any year, so no full-year executed figure exists for any Benin digital programme.

On access and skills, the state is building the delivery layer: a national tele-teaching platform authorised across four public universities for 2026–27, a hub network with a Sorbonne partnership, and a francophone digital-skills programme. The digital agency's certification course for state information-system security officers [opened a cohort of 25 on 2026-08-03](#), taking the trained total to about 85 (2026-08) against the agency's own target of 100 by end-2026, with intake now open to local authorities, state enterprises and the private sector.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Quarterly budget execution reports (RAPEX)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Latest instalment held covers to 31 March 2025
Annual performance reports required by the organic budget law	NOT HELD	—
Audited figures for any digital budget line	NOT HELD	—

(narrative not yet written)

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Government AI super app	Any statement, screenshot, service listing or usage figure establishing that the 'Super App IA Gouvernementale' counted among the presidential programme's existing foundations exists, is deployed or is used.	2026-08-04
India digital cooperation	A bilateral MoU, DPI cooperation programme document or ministerial readout naming a Benin-India digital instrument.	2026-08-04
Annual performance reports required by the organic budget law	A Rapport annuel de performance for any gestion; none has ever been published, so no full-year executed figure exists for any Benin digital programme.	2026-08-04
Audited figures for any digital budget line	A Cour des comptes rapport sur l'exécution des lois de finances after 2023, or the published text of loi n° 2026-06 settling gestion 2024.	2026-08-04

Four subjects carry no reliable statement of position, each probed once on 2026-08-04. One returned a route and is now an acquisition line: the budget directorate's published execution reports, a different instrument from the performance reports the organic law requires and the only published route to executed figures.

Three absences stand, dated: no Cour des comptes report on the execution of the finance laws after 2023. Benin is not among the twenty-four countries named in India's own list of digital-infrastructure partnerships. And nothing establishes that the government AI super app counted among the presidential programme's existing foundations exists, is deployed or is used.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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